መጽሐፈ፡ ግጽው፡ ※ The Book of Gitsew

Introduction

The *Book of Gitsew*, is the third of the 4 Books of the Sinodos (*vide infra*); together with the *Book of Abtilis*, it provides two versions of one body of law, governing the conduct of the clergy – the latter is the fuller of the two, and covers the same ground at greater length.

The Ge'ez text here presented is that of Winandus Fell's 1871 transcription[§], which he constructed from 3 *MSS*: *Berlin Or 398* (‘***Codex A***’, 17th Century), *Berlin Or 396* (‘***Codex B***’, 18th Century) and a *MS* held in the Tubingen Public Library, *M. a. IX. 7* (‘***Codex T***’). The English text is, essentially, that of Breandan Lumpkin's 2026 translation[¶]. The work is also preserved in Arabic, Syriac, and Coptic *MSS*, and in Greek fragments.

The manuscripts count this book differently: Fell's text, printed from three copies, gives fifty-seven canons; of the British Library *MSS*, one numbers fifty-seven, while another lists fifty-six in its table of contents but carries only fifty-four in the body. The fuller count is followed here. Bausi identifies it as the recension in fifty-six canons, "traditionally called Gitsew," which he glosses as a Ge'ez word meaning exposition, and as the only one of the four recensions of the Apostolic Canons published before his own edition.

Authorship and Dates

Church tradition attributes the text of the *Book of Gitsew* to the Twelve Apostles. Within the Ethiopian tradition, the sections of the Sinodos (including Te'ezaz, Gitsew, and Abtilis) are sometimes colloquially referred to as the *Books of Clement* (specifically 1st, 2nd, and 3rd Clement). This implies they were pseudo-historically communicated by St Peter to his disciple, Clement of Rome.

However, modern textual scholarship establishes that the Sinodos is a compilation of pseudepigraphal church orders, local council decrees (such as Nicaea, Antioch, and Laodicea), and liturgical statutes. The text was written by anonymous Christian redactors in Egypt and the Levant, who compiled various traditional early Christian pseudo-apostolic rulings into singular volumes.

§ Winandus Fell, "*Canones Apostolorum Aethiopice*," Leipzig: F. A. Brockhaus, 1871.

¶ Breandan Lumpkin, "*The Ethiopian Sinodos: Lost Books of the Ethiopian Bible*," Fifth Estate Publishing, Blountsville, AL, 2026.

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በስመ፡ አብ፡ ወወልድ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ አሐዱ፡ አምላክ።

ዝንቱ፡ ሲኖዶስ፡ ዘቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘወሀብዎ፡ ሐዋርያት፡ በእደ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፡ ዘለአክዎ፡ ቀዲሙ።

PROLOGUE

In the name of the Father, and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, one God.

This is the Synod of the Church, which the Apostles handed down by the hand of Clement, whom they sent long ago. [i]

[i] Another possible reading for '*long ago*' is '*in the beginning*'.

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በእንተ፡ ስፍነ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ የሀልዉ፡ በሚመተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ።

ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በ፪፡ አው፡ በ፫ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፤ ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ወእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን፡ ይሠየሙ፡ በመባሕተ፡ ፩ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ።

CANON 1

HOW MANY BISHOPS OUGHT TO BE PRESENT AT THE ORDINATION OF A BISHOP

Let a bishop be ordained by two or three bishops. But let a presbyter and a deacon and the rest of the clergy be ordained by one bishop only. [i]

CANON 1

[i] All the *MSS* read **በመባሕተ፡ ፩ኤጲስ፡** (‘*with the permission of one bishop*’) and Fell’s printed Ge’ez keeps it, as does his Latin; ‘*by one bishop only*’ is his conjecture in the note, made on the similar word **በባሕተቱ** (‘*alone*’) and it is the reading followed here. Recension II adds that ordinations are to be held on the Lord’s Day.

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በእንተ፡ ዘመፍትው፡ ያብኡ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ።

ለእመ፡ አብአ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዑ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ባዕደ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ዘአዘዝነ፡ ዘያብኡ፡ ወያዕርጉ፡ ቍርባነ፤ አው፡ ያበውእ፡ መዓረ፡ አው፡ ሐሊበ፡ አው፡ እምአዕዋፍ፡ አው፡ እምእንስሳ፡ ካልእ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ዘአዘዘ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ለይትመተር። ወኢይደሉ፡ ያብኡ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ሠዊት፡ ወአስካል፡ በመዋዕሊሁ፡ ወቅብአ፡ መጎቶት፡ ንጹሕ፡ ወዕጣን፡ በጊዜ፡ ቍርባን፡ ንጹሕ። ወእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ፍሬያት፡ ይፈንዉ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤት፡ ወይኩን፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወለቀሳውስት፤ ወባሕቱ፡ ኢያብእዎሙ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ። ወይትካፈልዎሙ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወቀሳውስት፡ ወለእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን።

CANON 2

ON THE THINGS THAT OUGHT TO BE BROUGHT TO THE ALTAR

If any bishop or presbyter brings to the altar of the Lord anything other than what we commanded to be brought and offered – whether honey, or milk,[i] or anything of birds or of other beasts, beyond what our Lord appointed – let him be deposed. Nor is it lawful to bring anything else to the altar except ears of corn and grapes in their season, and oil for the holy lamp, and incense at the time of the holy sacrifice. Let the other fruits be sent to the house, and let them belong to the bishop and the presbyters; but let them not bring them to the altar. And let the bishop and the presbyters distribute them also to the rest of the clergy.

CANON 2

[i] The Coptic adds '*intoxicating drink made in place of wine*' (ⲓⲉ ⲟⲩⲥⲓⲕⲉⲣⲱⲛ ⲉ̀ⲁⲩⲑⲁⲙⲓⲟⲩ ⲉ̀ⲡⲓⲛⲁ ⲛ̄ⲟⲩⲏⲣⲡ) and *Abtilis* has '*wine made by fire*', or '*wine made by the sun*'.

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ወኢይስድዱ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ብእሲቶ፡ በምክንያተ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር። ወለእመ፡ ሰደዱ፡ ይትፈለጡ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኢያግብእዋ፡ ወኢያብእዋ፡ ይትመተሩ።

CANON 3

Do not let a bishop or presbyter or deacon put away his wife under pretext of the divine service[i]. If they do put her away, let them be excommunicated; and, if they do not bring her back and receive her, let them be deposed.

CANON 3

[i] For '*the divine service*', the Greek reads εὐλάβεια ('*reverence*').

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በእንተ፡ ዕለት፡ ዘመፍትው፡ ይግበሩ፡ ፋሲካ።

ወለእመ፡ ገብረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ቅድስተ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ምስለ፡ አይሁድ፡ እምቅድመ፡ ይዔሪ፡ ሌሊት፡ ወመዓልት፡ ለይትመተሩ።

CANON 4

ON THE DAY ON WHICH PASCHA SHOULD BE CELEBRATED

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon celebrates the Holy Pascha with the Jews, before night and day are equal, let them be cut off[i].

CANON 4

[i] The Ge'ez reads **ለይትመተሩ** (plural, '*let them be cut off*'); both Fell and the fifty-six-canon collection give the plural and the penalty of cutting off.

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ወኢይደመሩ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ውስተ፡ ተግባረ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ዓለም። ወለእመ፡ ተደመሩ፡ ይትፈለጡ።

CANON 5

Let not bishop and presbyter and deacon entangle themselves in the affairs of this world; and if they do entangle themselves, let them be deposed.

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እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ አሐዱ፡ እምካህናት፡ ዘኢተመጠወ፡ ቍርባነ፡ በጊዜ፡ ቅዳሴ፡ ይንግር፡ ምክንያተ፡ በዝንቱ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ዘኢይደልዎ፡ ይሰረይ፡ ሎቱ። ወለእመ፡ ኢነገረ፡ ምክንያቶ፡ ይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ መርሐ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ጎጢአተ፡ ወረሰዮሙ፡ ይትዐቀፉ፡ ላዕለ፡ ዘአዕረገ፡ ቍርባነ፡ ከመ፡ ዘኢያዕረገ፡ በንጽሕ።

CANON 6

If any bishop, or any one of the clergy, does not receive the oblation at the time of the Liturgy, let him state the cause of it; and if something has befallen him that makes him unworthy,[i] let pardon be granted him. But, if he does not state his cause, let him be excommunicated, since he has become to men the author of scandal, and has caused them to take offence at him who offered the sacrifice, as though he had not sacrificed in purity.

CANON 6

[i] For '*and if something has befallen him that makes him unworthy*', the Greek reads καὶ ἐὰν μὴ αἰτία εὔλογος ('*and if there is a reasonable cause*'), which has the same sense as the Coptic.

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ኵሉ፡ መሃይምን፡ ዘይበውእ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወይሰምዕ፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ ወኢይቀውም፡ እስከ፡ ይገብሩ፡ ጸሎተ፡ ወኢይትሜጠው፡ ቍርባነ፡ ቅዱሰ፡ ወኢይጸልዩ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ ወይደልዎ፡ ይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ገብረ፡ ጋእዘ፡ ወሁከተ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

CANON 7

Any believer who enters the church and hears the Scriptures, but does not remain until the prayers are ended, nor receives the holy oblation – let them make no prayers for such a one. Separation is his due, since he prepares strife and disturbance for the church.

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ወለእመቦ፡ ዘጸለየ፡ ምስለ፡ ዘኢይሳተፍ፡ ምስጢረ፡ ወለእመሂ፡ በቤት፡ ይሰደድ።

CANON 8

If anyone prays with one who has no part in the Mystery,[i] even in his own house, let him be excommunicated.

CANON 8

[i] Fell here adds '*that is, with one who has been cut off*' (in parentheses). The Coptic text has the same sense: ⲛⲉⲙ ⲡⲉⲧ ⲕⲟⲓⲛⲱⲛⲓⲛ ⲁⲛ ⲙ̄ⲙⲩⲥⲧⲏⲣⲓⲟⲛ.

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ወኢይጸልዩ፡ ምስለ፡ ዘተሰደ።

ወለእመ፡ ጸለየ፡ አሐዱ፡ እምካህናት፡ ምስለ፡ አሐዱ፡ ካህን፡ ዘተሰደ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ።

CANON 9

AND THEY SHALL NOT PRAY WITH ONE CUT OFF[i]

If any cleric prays with a cleric who has been cut off, let him too be excommunicated.

CANON 9

[i] In an earlier version of his text, Lumpkin had a longer subtitle: *THAT CLERGY SHOULD NOT PRAY WITH A CLERIC WHO HAS BEEN CUT OFF*.

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ወለእመ፡ ሖረ፡ አሐዱ፡ እምካህናት፡ አው፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ዘተሰደ፡ ውስተ፡ ሀገር፡ ከመ፡ ዘኢተሰደ፡ ወይበውእ፡ ውስተ፡ ይእቲ፡ ሀገር፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕት፡ ወይሠየም፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱሂ፡ ወዘሤሞሂ። ወለእመ፡ ሀሎ፡ አፍኣ፡ ይሰደድ፡ እንተ፡ አፍአሁ፡ ነዋኅ፡ መዋዕለ፤ እስመ፡ ሐሰወ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያኑ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር።

CANON 10

If any cleric or layman who has been cut off goes to another city as though he were not cut off, and enters that city without permission[i] and is ordained: let both he and the one who ordained him be excommunicated. But, if he had already been cut off, let him be cut off for a longer time, because he has deceived the church of the Lord.

CANON 10

[i] After '*permission*', Fell adds in his Latin translation *episcopi* ('*of the bishop*') in brackets.

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ኢመፍትው፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ይጎድግ፡ ሢመቶ፡ ወይሠየም፡ ኀበ፡ ካልእ፡ ወለእመ፡ አስተሓመምዎ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክንያተ፡ ረባሕ፡ ወያስተሓምምዎ፡ ከመ፡ ይግበር፡ ከማሁ፡ እስመ፡ ይክል፡ ያርብሖሙ፡ ለእለ፡ በህየ፡ በነገረ፡ ጽድቅ። ወዘንተኒ፡ ኢይግበር፡ በባሕቲቱ፤ አላ፡ በፍትሐ፡ ብዙኃን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ወበዐቢይ፡ አስተብቍዖት፡ ፈድፋደ።

CANON 11

It is not lawful for a bishop to abandon his own office and be ordained in another;[i] and, if the people remove him without just cause, let them also be removed, because he is able to increase those who are there in the matter of truth. But let him not do this alone, upon his own authority, but by the judgment of many bishops and upon the greatest entreaty.

CANON 11

[i] Lumpkin ends the first sentence: *even though the people should urge him to it – unless it be for the good, and unless they urge him to do that which might offer some benefit to those who are there by the word of truth.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፪።

እመሂ፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ አሐዱ፡ እመዓርገ፡ ክህነት፡ ጎደገ፡ መንበሮ፡ ወሖረ፡ ጎበ፡ ካልእ፡ መንበር፡ ወይነብር፡ በውእቱ፡ መካን፡ ነዋኅ፡ መዋዕለ፡ ፈሊሰ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይትለአክ፡ ለዓለም፤ ወፈድፋደሰ፡ ለእመ፡ ለአከ፡ ጎቤሁ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይግባእ፡ ጎበ፡ መካኑ፡ ወኢሰምዖ፡ ይሰደድ፡ እምኂመቱ፡ ወይቅረብ፡ በመካን፡ ጎበ፡ ሀሎ፡ ከመ፡ ሕዝባዊ። ወለእመ፡ ተወክፎ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘሀሎ፡ ጎቤሁ፡ ከመ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ወይሬኢ፡ ዘንተ፡ ኵነኔ፡ ዘፈታሕነ፡ ከመ፡ ከንቱ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ መምህረ፡ ዕልወተ፡ ሕግ።

CANON 12

If any presbyter or deacon or anyone from the grades of the clergy abandons his own see and goes off to another, and remains there wandering many days without the bishop's permission: him we order to exercise his office no longer. And if the bishop moreover sends to him that he should return to his own place, and he does not obey: let him be separated from his office, and in the place where he is let him communicate as a layman. But, if the bishop with whom he is staying receives him as a cleric, and reckons as nothing this decree which we have made: let this bishop also be excommunicated, as a teacher of the breaking of law.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፫።

በእንተ፡ ዘአውሰበ፡ ክልኤተ፡ አው፡ ማዕሰበ።

ዘአውሰበ፡ ክልኤተ፡ አው፡ ዕቅብተ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ጥምቀት፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወኢቀሲስ፡ ወኢዲያቆን፡ ወኢይደሉ፡ ይትጐለቍ፡ ምስለ፡ ሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፡ ግሙራ።

ዘአውሰበ፡ ማዕሰበ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡ ተሐዘብዋ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡ አስተኀፈርዋ፡ አው፡ ዘማዊተ፡ አው፡ አመተ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡ ተሐውር፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወኢቀሲስ፡ ወኢዲያቆን፡ ወኢይትጐለቍ፡ ግሙራ፡ እምሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፤ አው፡ ዘነበረ፡ ምስለ፡ ክልኤ፡ አኃት፡ አው፡ ወለተ፡ እኁሁ፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይኩን፡ ካህነ።

CANON 13

ON HIM WHO HAS MARRIED TWICE OR MARRIED A WIDOW

He who, after baptism, has taken two wives, or a concubine, cannot be ordained bishop or presbyter or deacon, nor ought he in any way to be numbered among the clergy.

He who has married a widow, or a woman under suspicion, or one who has been put to shame,[i] or a harlot, or a maidservant, or an actress, cannot be ordained bishop or presbyter or deacon, nor be numbered among the clergy. Nor can he be a cleric who has lived with two sisters, or with his brother's daughter.

CANON 13

[i] In place of '*one who has been put to shame*', the Greek text has '*one who has been divorced*' (*ἐκβεβλημένην*); Fell's Ge'ez here (**እንተ፡ አስተኀፈርዋ፡**) follows the Coptic (ⲟⲩⲓ ⲉⲁⲩⲥⲁϣⲥ).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፬።

ካህን፡ ዘይትሐበይ፡ ብእሴ፡ ይትመተር።

CANON 14

A cleric who gives surety, let him be deposed. [i]

CANON 14

[i] The Coptic reads rather '*One who (takes) a man as a pledge*' (ⲉⲑⲛⲁⲥⲓ ⲣⲱⲙⲓ ⲉⲃⲟⲗⲉⲡⲧⲱⲣⲓ). After '*surety*', Lumpkin adds '*for anyone*'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፭።

በእንተ፡ ጎጽዋን።

ለእመ፡ ተጎጽወ፡ እምሰብእ፡ በትዕግልት፡ አው፡ ለእመ፡ መተርዎ፡ ጎፍረቶ፡ በውስተ፡ ጸብእ፡ አው፡ ተወልደ፡ ከማሁ፡ ለእመ፡ ይደልዎ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሰ። ወእመሰ፡ ጎጸወ፡ ርእሶ፡ በመባሕቱ፡ ኢይኩን፡ እምሥዩማን፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ቀታሌ፡ ነፍሱ፡ ወጸላኤ፡ ለፍጥረተ፡ እግዚአብሔር። ወ፩እምሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ መተረ፡ ጎፍረቶ፡ ይሰዐር፤ እስመ፡ ቀታሌ፡ ነፍሱ፡ ውእቱ፡ ባሕቲቱ። ወሕዝባዊ፡ ዘየሐጹ፡ ርእሶ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ሠለስተ፡ ዓመተ፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ፀረ፡ ለሕይወቱ፡ ባሕቲቱ።

CANON 15

CONCERNING EUNUCHS

If anyone has been made a eunuch by force at the hands of men, or if in war[i] his manhood was cut away, or if he was so born, and he is worthy: let him be ordained bishop. But if he has castrated himself by his own authority, he cannot become a cleric, since he is his own murderer and has made himself an enemy of the creation of God. And if any cleric cuts off his own members: let him be deposed, since he is nothing other than his own murderer. But a layman who cuts himself, let him be cut off for three years, since he has become an enemy of his own life.

CANON 15

[i] Fell doubts whether the Ge'ez word here rendered '*war*' (**ጸብእ**) can carry the sense of the Greek διωγμός ('*persecution*'), and notes that the lexica do not record it.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፮።

በእንተ፡ ዘዘመወ፡ እው፡ መሐል፡ በሐሰት፡ አው፡ ሰረቀ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘይትረከብ፡ በዝሙት፡ አው፡ በመሐላ፡ ሐሰት፡ አው፡ በሰሪቅ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ወኢይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ይብል፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ኢይትቤቀል፡ ካዕበ፡ በኀአበሳ።

CANON 16

ON HIM WHO HAS FORNICATED OR SWORN FALSELY OR STOLEN

A bishop or presbyter or deacon who has been caught in fornication or perjury or theft, let him be deposed; but let him not be cut off. For, God says[i], "The Lord will not exact vengeance twice for one crime."

CANON 16

[i] Fell prints '*the Scripture says*', supplying the subject; the Ge'ez names God, and he allows this alternative in his notes. The reading above follows the Ge'ez.

ትእዛይ፡ ፲ወ፯።

[i]ወካዕበ፡እለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን።

እለ፡ እሙንቱ፡ እናጕንስጢስ፡ ወመዘምራን፡ ሶበ፡ ይበውኡ፡ ውስተ፡ ክህነት፡ ወፈቀዱ፡ አውስቦ፡ ያውስቡ፤ ወንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዞሙ፡ ለባሕቲቶሙ፡ እንዘ፡ ሀለዉ፡ አናጕንስጢስ፡ ያውስቡ። ወባሕቱ፡ ኢይከውኖሙ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ተሠይሙ።

CANON 17

AND SO THE REST OF THE CLERGY [ii]

Those who are readers and cantors, if they enter the clergy and wish to take a wife, let them take one. But we order them to marry only while they are readers; it is not lawful for them once they have attained a higher order.

CANON 17

[i] The last letter of the first word in the title is clearly wrong (Fell marks it with an over-written ‘X’) – the word should obviously read **ትእዛዝ** (as elsewhere).

[ii] Fell notes that the text here given as the subtitle should possibly be part of the preceding canon.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፰።

በእንተ፡ ካህን፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ኵሎ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ክርስቲያናዌ፡ አው፡ ዘኢየአምን፡ ሶበ፡ ይኤብስ፡ ወይፈቅድ፡ በዝንቱ፡ ግብር፡ ከመ፡ ዘያፈርሆሙ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ይሰዐር፤ እስመ፡ ኢአዘዘ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ከመ፡ ንግበር፡ ዘንተ፡ ወኢበአሐቲ፡ መካን፤ እስመ፡ ሶበ፡ ይዘብጥዎ፡ ኢዘበጠ፡ ወእንዘ፡ ይጼዕልዎ፡ ኢጸዐለ፡ ወእንዘ፡ ያሐምምዎ፡ ኢተቀየመ፡ ወኢተምዕዐ።

CANON 18

CONCERNING A CLERIC WHO STRIKES ANYONE

A bishop or presbyter who strikes a Christian or an unbeliever after he has sinned, and by this means wishes to strike terror into men, we order to be deposed. For nowhere did our Lord instruct us to do this; because when they struck him, he did not strike; and when they cursed him, he did not curse; and when they afflicted him with pain, he neither prepared vengeance nor was angry.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፱።

በእንተ፡ ዘተሰዕረ፡ በርቱዕ፡ አምካህናት።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘተሰዕረ፡ በርቱዕ፡ በእንተ፡ ኀጢአት፡ ዘተዐውቀ፡ ደፈረ፡ ወቀርበ፡ ይእኅዝ፡ መልእክቶ፡ እንተ፡ ትካት፡ [በመዋዕለ፡ መባሕት፡] ወዝንቱ፡ ይርሐቅ፡ እምቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ግሙራ።

CANON 19

ON ONE JUSTLY DEPOSED FROM THE CLERGY

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon, justly deposed for a manifest crime, is insolent and comes forward to occupy his former office [on the days of the offering[i]]: let him depart from the church altogether.

CANON 19

[i] Fell does not translate the words given in brackets, noting that they are obscure and suggesting they may be a gloss on **እንተ፡ ትካት፡** (‘*former*’). Alternatively, following the reading of *Codex B* (**በመዋዕለ፡ መስሕት፡**), one might translate ‘*in the days of offence*’ – meaning, if he dared to resume his former office without having been absolved of the crime and without having been granted permission to take up the duty again. Or did the Ethiopic translator of the Coptic (mis)read ⲛ̄ⲥⲛⲟⲩ ⲛⲓⲃⲉⲛ (‘*in the days of sin*’) instead of ⲛ̄ⲥⲛⲟⲩ ⲛⲟⲃⲉ (‘*in all days*’, i.e., always)?

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ በሕልያን።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘይእኅዝ፡ መዓርገ፡ ክህነት፡ በሕልያን፡ ይሰዐር። ወይሰዐር፡ ዘሢሞሂ፡ ወይትመተር፡ ለዝሉፉ፡ እምሥርዐተ፡ ክህነት፡ ወኢይሳተፍዎ፡ ወኢበምንተ[i]ኒ፤ በከመ፡ ረሰይክዎ፡ ለሲሞን፡ መሠርይ፡ እምኀቤየ፡ አነ፡ ጴጥሮስ።

CANON 20

ON HIM WHO HAS BEEN ORDAINED BY GIFTS

If any bishop, presbyter, or deacon obtains the dignity of the clergy by gifts, let him be deposed; and let him also be deposed who ordained him, and let him be cut off forever from the order of priesthood.[ii] And let them have no fellowship with him – even as I, Peter, removed Simon Magus from me.

CANON 20

[i] Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

[ii] Lumpkin ends the sentence, "…*and let him be shut out for ever from the administration of the priesthood*."

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፩።

በእንተ፡ ዘይትራዳእ፡ ከመ፡ ይእኀዝ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

ለእመ፡ ተራድአ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ምኵናነ፡ በመኳንንት፡ ዝንቱ፡ ዓለም፡ ወይመልክ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘእምኀቤሆሙ፡ ለይትመተር፡ ወይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወኵሎሙ፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎ።

CANON 21

ON HIM WHO SEEKS HELP TO OBTAIN A CHURCH

If any bishop obtains a prefecture by the help of the princes of this world, and possesses a church through them: let him be deposed. And let both he himself and those who cleave to him be cut off.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ወ፪።

በእንተ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘይሜንን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ።

ለእመ፡ መነነ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወይተፈለጥ፡ ወይገብር፡ ሎቱ፡ ምሥዋዐ፡ እንዘ፡ ኢይትረከብ፡ ላዕለ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ጌጋይ፡ በውስተ፡ ፍትሕ፡ በእንተ፡ ግብረ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ እንዘ፡ ይረትዕ፡ ለይሰዐር፡ ከመ፡ መፍቀሬ፡ ሢመት፡ ውእቱ፡ ወኵሎሙ፡ ካህናት፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎ፤ እስመ፡ ዐላዊ፡ ውእቱ። ወሕዝባውያን፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎ፡ ይሰደዱ። ወዝንቱ፡ ይከውን፡ ሶበ፡ ይሴአሎሙ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ምዕረ፡ ወካዕበ፡ ወሠልሰ።

CANON 22

ON A PRESBYTER WHO DESPISES HIS BISHOP

If a presbyter despises his bishop, and separates himself from him, and builds an altar for himself – while in judgment no crime is found in the bishop, since he is innocent by reason of his divine office – let him be deposed as one greedy for dignity, and with him all the clerics who cleave to him, because he is a rebel. But the laymen who cleave to him, let them be cut off. And let this be done when the bishop has exhorted them once, and twice, and a third time.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፫ዊ።

በእንተ፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘሰደዶ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ለእመ፡ ሰደደ፡[i] **ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆነ ፡ካልእ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ኢይኅድን፡ ይባእ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ለእመ፡ አብሖ፡ ውእቱ፡ ሰደዶ፡ አው፡ ለእመ፡ ሞተ።**

CANON 23

ON A PRESBYTER OR DEACON WHOM THE BISHOP HAS CUT OFF

If any bishop cuts off a presbyter or a deacon, let no other bishop receive him, unless he who cut him off permits it, or unless he is dead.

CANON 23

[i] There is no doubt that (with the Coptic version agreeing) **ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡** must be supplied before **ለእመ፡ ሰደደ፡** . Otherwise, **ሰደደ፡** would have to be changed to **ተሰደ** (*'[if any presbyter or deacon] has been separated'* – namely, by the bishop).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፬።

ኢይትወከፍ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ነኪር፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ እለ፡ ይትመጠው፡ ከመ፡ ንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ለእመበሙ፡ መባሕተ፡ ይሠየሙ፡ ወይደመሩ። ወለእመ፡ ኮኑ፡ ዜናውያነ፡ ጽድቅ፡ ይባኡ፤ ወእመ፡ እኮ፡ ዘይፈቅዱ፡ የሀብዎሙ፡ ወኢይደመሩ፤ እስመቦ፡ ብዙኃን፡ እሰ፡ ከመዝ፡ ከመ፡ ርሱሕ።

CANON 24

Let no foreign bishop receive a presbyter or a deacon – those who are received as lesser clergy[i] – unless they have permission to be ordained and joined to him. And, if they are preachers of the truth, let them be received. But if not, whatever they desire, do not give them, nor let them administer; for, there are many like this.[ii]

CANON 24

[i] I.e., those who come to him to be received as lower-ranking clerics. However, Fell strongly doubts whether his translation of the rather obscure words **እለ፡ ይትመጠው፡ ከመ፡ ንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡**, or if the reading of *Codex T* (**እላ፡**) should be preferred instead (‘*but let him receive [them] as lower-ranking clerics*’). Furthermore, judging by the *MSS*, it is uncertain whether one should read **ይትመጠው** or **ይትመጠዉ**.

[ii] For the last two sentences, Lumpkin reads: *But if not, let there be given them what they ask, that is, whatever they need; but let them not be joined to him. For there are many wicked men of this kind.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ወ፭።

መፍትው፡ ያእምር፡ ሊቀ፡ ጳጳሳት፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳተ፡ ኵሉ፡ ብሔር። ወይደልዎሙ፡ ያእምርዎ፡ መኑ፡ ውእቱ፡ ቀዳሚ፡ በጎቤሆሙ፡ ወይስምይዎ፡ ሊቀ፤ ወኢይግበሩ፡ ዐቢየ፡ ምክረ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ዘየዐቢ፤ ወይግበሩ፡ ለለ፩ግብሮሙ፡ ዘይደልዎሙ፡ ለሚመቶሙ፡ ወለሕዝብ፡ እለ፡ ውስተ፡ ምኵናኖሙ። ወባሕቱ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ ሊቀ፡ ላዕሌሆሙ፡ ኢይግበር፡ ወኢምንትኒ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ኵሎሙ፤ ከመዝ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ይኩኑ፡ አሐደ፡ ኅብረተ፡ ወይሴባሕ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ።

ወኢይትኅበል፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይሚም፡ አፍአ፡ እምኵናኑ፡ ኅበ፡ ዘኢኮነ፡ ዚአሁ፡ አዕጻዳተ። ወለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ከመ፡ ገብረ፡ ዘንተ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ምክረ፡ ርእሰ፡ ውእቱ፡ መካን፡ ወአዕጻዳት፡ ወአህጉር፡ ለይሰዐር፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወእለ፡ ሤሞሙኒ።

CANON 25

The metropolitan[i] ought to know the bishops of the whole province; and these ought to know which among them is first, and to name him their head. Nor let them take a great counsel without the counsel of the greater. Let each one manage his own affair, which belongs to him by reason of his own office and of the people who are under their governance. But let not even he who is set over them as metropolitan do anything without the counsel of all the bishops. [ii] So, all may be one, and God will be glorified through Christ Jesus and the Holy Spirit.

Let no bishop dare to make an ordination outside his own office, in districts that do not pertain to him. And, if he is found to have done this without the knowledge of him who holds the primacy in that place and in those villages and cities: let both he and those he ordained be deposed.

CANON 25

[i] Where this canon says '*metropolitan*', the Ge'ez may equally be rendered '*patriarch*'.

[ii] Lumpkin opens the sentence, "*In this way, let them all form one fellowship.*"

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፮ኛ።

ወለእመ፡ ተሠይመ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ወኢገሠጸ፡ ወኢጎለየ፡ በእንተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ዘተውህበ፡ ሎቱ፡ ይትፈለጥ፡ እስከ፡ ይጌሥጽ፤ ወከመዝ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን። ወእመ፡ ሖረ፡ ወኢየኀድግ፡ ከመ፡ ይባእ፡ ወአኮ፡ ውእቱ፡ በምክሩ፡ አላ፡ በምክረ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ወለሊሁሰ፡ ይንበር፡ እንዘ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ውእቱ፤ ወካህናትሰ፡ እለ፡ ውስተ፡ ሀገር፡ ይትፈለጡ፤ እስመ፡ ኢመሀሩ፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ከመዝ።

CANON 26

If any bishop has been ordained, and has not taught nor taken care of the people committed to him: let him be cut off until he teaches. And, in the same way, presbyter and deacon. But, if he goes to teach and the people refuse to receive him, through their decision rather than his own, let the bishop retain his office; but let the clergy of that city be cut off, because they did not admonish the people in such a case. [i]

CANON 26

[i] Fell's Latin contrasts the bishop's decision with the people's, and the reading above follows him; the passage involves editorial reconstruction and comparison with the Coptic (ⲉⲁⲩⲱⲡ ⲇⲉ ⲁⲛⲁⲅⲛⲱⲥⲓⲁⲛ ⲛⲉⲁⲩⲧⲉⲙϩⲁⲛ ⲉⲃⲟⲩⲛ); it is not an unproblematic Ge'ez reading.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፯ኛ።

ወይኩን፡ ጉባኤ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ካዕበ፡ በበዓመት፡ ወይጠይቁ፡ በእንተ፡ ሥርዐተ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወይፈክሩ፡ ስሕተታተ፡ ወዕቅፍተ፡ ዘይከውን፡ በቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን። ወቀዳሚ፡ ጉባኤ፡ ይኩን፡ በመንፈቀ፡ ጰንጠቆስጤ፤ ወካልእ፡ ጉባኤ፡ አመ፡ ፲ወ፪ለጥቅምት።

CANON 27

Let a synod of bishops be held twice in the year; and let them examine the administration of the divine office, and set right the errors and offences which are in the church. Let the first synod be held at mid-Pentecost, and the second synod on the twelfth day of the month Tekemt. [i]

CANON 27

[i] '*Tekemt*' (**ጥቅምት**) begins on the 10th of October, and answers to the Roman October. Mid-Pentecost is the fourth week after the Pascha; the Arabic titles read plainly '*in the fourth week after the Pascha*'. From this apostolic decree, the Abyssinian church took the name of a feast kept on the 18th of Miyazya, which they call the Feast of the Assembly of the Bishops.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ወ፰።

CANON 28

ወየኀሊ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በእንተ፡ ንዋየ፡[i] ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወይሥርየሙ፡ ከመዘ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ነጸረ፡ ላዕሌሁ። ወኢይደልዎ፡ ይንሣእ፡ እምኔሆሙ፡ ረባሐ፡ ሎቱ፡ ለባሕቲቱ። ወኢየሀብ፡ ንዋየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ለውሉደ፡ ዘመዱ፡ ወለእመሂ፡ ኮኑ፡ ነዳያነ። ወኢይደልዎ፡ ይንግድ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ በምክንያተ፡ እሙንቱ።

Let the bishop have the care of the goods of the church, and let him administer them as one upon whom the Lord looks. It is not lawful for him to take anything from them for himself alone as gain, nor to give the goods of the Lord to his own kindred, even though they are poor. Nor is it lawful for him to sell the goods of the church under pretext of them.

CANON 28

[i] Fell did not hesitate to supply the word **ንዋየ፡** before **ቤተ፡ክርስቲያን፡**, even though it is missing from the *MSS*. For, quite apart from the fact that this word appears in the Greek text as well as in all the versions, the plural suffixes on the words **ይሥርየሙ** and **እግዚአብሔር** already require it. In *Codex T*, **ላዕሌሁሙ** is read instead of **ላዕሌሁ**; its suffix must also refer to **ንዋየ** (as things which God looks on).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፱።

በእንተ፡ ተማክሮ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ።

ኢይግበር፡ ወኢመኑሂ፡ እምቀሳውስት፡ ወዲያቆናት፡ ወኢምንተኒ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ እስመ፡ ውእቱ፡ ዘተአምነ፡ ላዕለ፡ ሕዝበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወውእቱ፡ ካዕበ፡ ዘያወሥእ፡ በእንተ፡ ነፍሶሙ።

CANON 29

ON TAKING COUNSEL WITH THE BISHOP

Let none of the presbyters and deacons do anything except by the counsel of the bishop. For he it is to whom the people of God has been entrusted; and he it is also who will render account for their souls.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴።

ወያእምሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በባሕቲቱ፡ ለእመቦ፡ ንዋየ፤ ወያእምሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ከመ፡ ሶበ፡ ይመውት፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ይምልክ፡ ንዋዮ፡ ወየሀብ፡ ለዘፈቀደ፤ ከመ፡ ኢይትሀጐል፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በምክንያተ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ አው፡ ለእመቦ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ብእሲተ፡ ወውሉደ፡ ወአዝማደ፡ አው፡ አግብርተ፤ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡ ርቱዐ፡ ከመ፡ ይትሀጐል፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ እስመ፡ ኢያእመሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ ወከመ፡ ኢይትሀጐል፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወአዝማዱሁ፡ በእንተ፡ ምክንያተ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወይወድቁ፡ ውስተ፡ ጻማ፡ ወይዐርፉ፡ ላዕለ፡ ሞቱ።

CANON 30

And they shall know the bishop's own goods, if he has any of his own, and they shall know which are the Lord's goods; so that the bishop, if he is about to die, may dispose of his own goods and give them to whom he will. Otherwise, the bishop's goods will perish under pretext of the church's goods – or perhaps he has a wife and children and kindred or servants. For, it is not right[i] that the goods of the church should perish because men were ignorant of the bishop's goods; nor is it right that the goods of the bishop and of his kindred should perish under pretext of the church's goods, and that his kindred should fall into misery and speak ill of his death.

CANON 30

[i] The words **ኢኮነ፡ርቱዐ፡** (*'it is not right'*) are to be connected with what follows, even in the Coptic version. In the Greek and other versions, however, they are connected with the preceding clause.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፩።

በእንተ፡ ተአምኖ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ላዕለ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን። ንኤዝዝ፡ እንከ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘይመልክ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ዘተኣመነ፡ ላዕለ፡ ነፍሳተ፡ ሰብእ፡ ክቡር፤ ምንተ፡ እንከ፡ ኵሎ፡ ንዋየ፡ ዘተውህበ፡ ሎቱ፡ ከመ፡ የአዝዞሙ፡ በፈቃዱ፡ ወይሴሲ፡ ነዳያነ፡ እምኔሁ፡ በእደ፡ ቀሳውስት፡ ወዲያቆናት፡ በፈሪሀ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወበረዓድ። ወይርክብ፡ ለሊሁኒ፡ እምኔሁ፡ ለመፍቅዱ፡ ለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ጽኑሰ፡ በእንተ፡ ዘይፈቅዱ፡ በጎቤሁ፡ አኀው፡ ነግድ፡ እለ፡ ይሔውጽዎ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይኅጥአሙ፡ እምዘፈቀዱ፡ በጎቤሁ፤ እስመ፡ ሕገ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ይኤዝዞሙ፡ ለእለ፡ ይፀመዱ፡ ለምሥዋዕ፡ ይሴሰዩ፡ እምሥዋዕ፤ እስመ፡ ኢይጸብኡ፡ ሐራሁ፡ ለንጉሥ፡ ኀበ፡ ጸላእቱ፡ በሲሳየ፡ ነፍሶሙ።

CANON 31

So, we order that the bishop be the one who has authority over the goods of the church. For, he it is to whom the precious souls of men have been entrusted; how much more, then, that all the goods should be committed to him, that he may dispose of them according to his own judgment, and supply from them to the needy by the hands of the presbyters and deacons, with all fear of God and trembling. Let the bishop himself also take from them for his own necessity, if he is in want of those things that visiting brothers from abroad ask of him, lest they lack the things they sought from him. For, the law of the Lord commands that those who serve at the altar should also be fed from the altar; because the soldiers of the king do not fight against his enemy at their own charges.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴ወ፪።

በእንተ፡ እለ፡ የሐውሩ፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት፡ ወየዐውድ፡ ወያበዝኅ፡ ስካረ፡ ለይኅድግ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡ ይሰደድ። ንፍቀ፡ ዲያቆን፡ ወአናጕንስጢስ፡ ወመዘምራን፡ ለእመ፡ ገበ[i]ሩ፡ ዘንተ፡ ምግባረ፡ ለይኅድጉ፤ ወእመ፡ እኮ፡ ይሰደዱ።

ወከማሁ፡ ሕዝባውያንኒ። ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘያአምር፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ወኢየኅድግ፡ መፍትው፡ በድልው፡ ይክልአ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡ ይትመተር።

CANON 32

ON THOSE WHO FREQUENT THE PLAYS

A bishop or presbyter or deacon who frequents the plays, or wanders about, or gives himself to drunkenness, let him cease; if not, let him be cut off. A subdeacon and reader and cantor, if they do these things, let them cease; if not, let them be cut off. And so likewise the laity.

[ii] A bishop or presbyter or deacon who knows of one frequenting the plays and not ceasing ought properly to restrain him; if not, let him be deposed.

CANON 32

[i] Fell marks this letter with an over-written ‘X’, indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

[ii] The Ge’ez appears to be corrupt here. The Greek, Syriac and Coptic all treat instead of one who lends money at interest. Four canons that follow at this point in the Greek are absent from both the Ge’ez and the Coptic.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፫፡።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ኀበ፡ ጥምቀተ፡ ዕልዋን፡ አው፡ ኀበ፡ ቍርባኖሙ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ይትመተር። ምንተ፡ እንከ፡ ይእቲ፡ ሥምረቱ፡ ለክርስቶስ፡ ምስለ፡ ሰይጣን፤ ወአይ፡ ክፍል፡ ለመሃይምናን፡ ምስለ፡ ዘኢየአምን።

CANON 33

As for a bishop or presbyter or deacon who resorts to the baptism of the uncircumcised[i] or to their oblation, we command that he be deposed. For, what fellowship has Christ with Satan? And what partnership have the faithful with the unbeliever?

CANON 33

[i] In place of '*the uncircumcised*', Lumpkin has '*heretics*' (the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church practises circumcision).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴ወ፬።

በእንተ፡ ሥርዐቱ፡ ለዘያስተራኵስ፡ አውስቦ።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ ፩እምሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፡ ዘአበየ፡ አውስቦ፡ ወበሊዐ፡ ሥጋ፡ ወሰትየ፡ ወይን፡ ወአኮ፡ በእንተ፡ ተፀምዶ፡ አላ፡ ከመ፡ ርኩሳን፡ ወረሰዮሙ፡ መጽሐፍ፡[i] ከመ፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ሠናይ፡ ወእግዚአብሔር፡ ፈጠሮ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ተባዕተ፡ ወአንስተ፡ ወከመዝ፡ ውእቱ፡ ዘይዐርፍ፡ አይኅድግ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡ ለይትመተር፡ ወይፃእ፡ እምቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን። ወከማሁ፡ ሕዝባዊ።

Canon 34

On the Case of One who Reckons Marriage Unclean

A bishop or presbyter or deacon or any of the clergy who abhors marriage and the eating of flesh and the drinking of wine – and this by no means for the sake of temperance, but as though these things were foul, while the Scripture declares them all to be good, and God made man male and female – and who blasphemes in such a manner: let him cease; if not, let him be deposed and depart from the church. And so likewise a layman.

Canon 34

[i] Since all the *MSS* present **ወረሰዮሙ፡ መጽሐፍ፡**, Fell did not venture to alter this reading, even though the construction of the words is rather convoluted. He had no doubt, however – supported by the Greek (*ἐπιλαθόμενος*) and the Coptic versions (ⲉϩⲩⲉⲣⲡⲱⲃϣ) – that those words are a corruption of **ረሰዮሙ፡** (or rather, since a single person is involved, **ረሰየ፡**) **መጽሐፈ፡**, arising from a lapse of memory regarding the Scripture (which says): that all things are good. In fact, Recension II reads **ረሰዮሙ፡**.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፭።

በእንተ፡ ምትረቱ፡ ለዘኢይትዌከፎሙ፡ ለእለ፡ ይትኔሰሑ፡ እምኀጢአቶሙ።

ለእመ፡ ኢፈቀደ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ኢይትዌከፎ፡ ለዘይትኔሳሕ፡ እምኀጢአቱ፡ ለይትመተር፤ እስመ፡ አሕመመ፡ ልበ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ዘይቤ፡ይከውን፡ ፍሥሓ፡ በሰማያት፡ በእንተ፡ ፩ኃጥእ፡ ዘይትኔሳሕ።

CANON 35

ON THE DEPOSING OF ONE WHO DOES NOT RECEIVE THE PENITENT

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon does not receive one who is doing penance for his sin: let him be deposed, since he has grieved the heart of the Lord, who said, “There shall be joy in heaven over one sinner who repents.”

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፮።

ለእመ፡ ኢበልዐ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ንስቲተ፡ ሥጋ፡ ወኢሰትየ፡ ጎዳጠ፡ ወይነ፡ በመዋዕል፡ በዓላት፡ ወበጎቡእ፡ ያስተነፍሮሙ፡ ወኮነ፡ መርሐ፡ ለዕቅፍተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ለይትመተር።

CANON 36

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon does not eat a little flesh nor drink a little wine on feast days, and secretly judges these things to be foul, and in this way becomes to the people the cause of offence: let him be deposed.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴ወ፯።

ለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ዘይበልዕ፡ በውስተ፡ ምሥያጣት፡ ወይሰቲ፡ ይትፈለጥ፤ አላ፡ ለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ በማኅደረ፡ ነግድ፡ በእንተ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ በፍኖት።

ወለእመ፡ ጸዐለ፡ ፭እምሥዩማን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ለይትመተር፤ እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ ለመኰንነ፡ ሕዝብከ፡ ኢታሕሥም፡ ቃለ።

ወለእመ፡ ጸዐለ፡ ፩እምንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆነ፡ ይሰደድ።

ወለእመ፡ ተሳለቀ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ጽሙመ፡ አው፡ ሐንካሰ፡ አው፡ ዕዉረ፡ አው፡ ዘፅዉስ፡ እገሪሁ፡ ይሰደድ። ወከማሁ፡ ሕዝባዊኒ፤ ለእመ፡ ገብረ፡ ዘንተ።

CANON 37

If any of the clergy is caught eating and drinking in the markets: let him be cut off; unless it be done at a traveller's lodging out of necessity upon a journey.

And if any of the clergy treats the bishop with contempt: let him be deposed. For, it is said, "You shall not curse the ruler of your people."

And if any of the lower clergy treats a presbyter or deacon with contempt: let him be cut off.

And if any of the clergy mocks a man who is deaf or lame or blind or crippled in his feet: let him be cut off. And so likewise a layman who does such things.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፰ኛ።

በእንተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘኢይሜህር፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ተቀንዮ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘያሰትት፡ ለካህናት፡ ወለሕዝብ፡ ወኢይሜህሮሙ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ይሰደድ፤ ወለእመ፡ ነበረ፡ በአስትቶ፡ ይሰዐር።

CANON 38

ON A BISHOP OR PRESBYTER WHO DOES NOT TEACH THE PEOPLE THE WORSHIP OF GOD

A bishop or presbyter who neglects the clergy and the people, and does not teach them the divine office, let him be cut off; and if he persists in his negligence, let him be deposed.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴ወ፱።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ለእመ፡ ተሀየየ፡ በእንተ፡ ዘይጼነስ፡ እምካህናት፡ ወኢያስተማስሎ፡ በዘይሁቦ፡ ለመፍቅዱ፡ ይሰደድ። ወለእመ፡ ነበረ፡ በተሀይዮ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ከመ፡ ዘቀተለ፡ እጉሁ።

CANON 39

A bishop or presbyter who has no care for a cleric labouring in want, and does not repent of it, [i] let him be cut off. And, if he persists in his neglect: let him be deposed, as one who has killed his own brother.

CANON 39

[i] The translation, '*and does not repent of it*', is uncertain; Lumpkin reads '*and does not hold him as his equal, supplying him according to his need*' but this seems too long for the Ge'ez text.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵፩።

እመቦ፡ ዘአርአየ፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ ዘጸሐፉ፡ ዕልዋን፡ በሐሰት፡ ወአብአ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ከመ፡ ዘቅዱሳት፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ለመሥገረተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ወካህናት፡ ይሰዐር።

CANON 40

If anyone publishes books written falsely[i] by heretics, and brings them into the church as though they were holy books, to ensnare the people and the clergy: let him be deposed.

[i] The Coptic has '*in a lie or falsehood*' (ϧⲉⲛ ⲟⲩⲙⲉⲑⲛⲟⲩϫ).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፩።

በእንተ፡ ካህን፡ ዘይዛለፍዎ፡ ሕዝብ፡ በዝሙት፡ አው፡ ካልእ።

እመ፡ ኮነ፡ ጋእዘ[i]፡ ጎበ፡ መሃይምናን፡ በዝሙት፡ አው፡ በምርዐት፡ አው፡ በካልእ፡ ግብር፡ ዘኢይደሉ፡ ወለእመ፡ ተዛለፍዎ፡ ኢይኩን፡ እምካህናት።

CANON 41

ON A CLERIC WHOM THE PEOPLE CONVICT OF FORNICATION OR OTHER OFFENCE

If a cleric commits adultery or fornication or another act that is not right, and if they are accused of it, they shall not be among the clergy. [ii]

CANON 41

[i] Fell marks this letter with an over-written ‘X’, indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

[ii] Lumpkin has a rather longer text for this canon, but the sense is the same: *If among the faithful an accusation is brought concerning fornication or wantonness or any other deed that is unseemly, and they convict him: let him be no longer among the clergy.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵ወ፪።

በእንተ፡ ክሕደተ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወክሕደተ፡ ክህነት።

፩እምሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ ክሕደ፡ በእንተ፡ ፍርሀተ፡ ሰብእ፡ አው፡ እምአይሁድ፡ አው፡ እምአረሚ፡ ወዕልዋን፡ ለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ውእቱ፡ ስመ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ዘክሕደ፡ ይሰደድ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ውእቱ፡ ስመ፡ ክህነት፡ ይሰዐር። ወለእመ፡ ተነስሐ፡ ይትወከፍዎ፡ ወይባእ፡ ከመ፡ ሕዝባዊ።

CANON 42

ON DENYING CHRIST AND ON DENYING THE PRIESTHOOD[i]

If any of the clergy, through fear of men – whether of Jews, or of the heathen and heretics – makes denial: let him be cut off, if it is the name of Christ that he denied. But, if it was the name of the clergy: let him be deposed. And, if he does penance, let them receive him; but let him enter as a layman.

CANON 42

[i] In place of '*the Priesthood*', Lumpkin has '*the Dignity of the Clergy*'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵ወ፫።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ ፭እምካህናት፡ ሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ በልዐ፡ ሥጋ፡ ዘቦቱ፡ ደመ፡ ነፍሱ፡ ዘኢጥቡሕ፡ ኣው፡ ዘነሰኮ፡ አርዌ፡ አው፡ ማውታ፡ ለይሰወር፡ ውእቱ፤ በከመ፡ አዘዘ፡ ቦቱ፡ ሕግ። ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ።

CANON 43

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon or any of the clergy eats flesh in which is the blood of its life, not slaughtered, or torn by beasts, or that died of itself: let him be deposed, as the law appoints in this matter. And, if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵ወ፬።

ለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ዘይጸውም፡ በዕለተ፡ እሑድ፡ አው፡ በዕለተ፡ ሰንበት፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ሰንበት፡ ዐባይ፡ ባሕቲታ፡ እንተ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ይሰዐር።

CANON 44

If any of the clergy is found to have fasted on the Lord's Day or on the Sabbath – except only on the Great Sabbath of the Pascha[i]: let him be deposed.

CANON 44

[i] The words, **እንተ፡ፋሲካ፡** (*'of the Pascha'*) are also included in the Coptic (ⲛ̄ⲧⲉ ⲡⲡⲁⲥⲭⲁ).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፭።

CANON 45

ለእመ፡ ቦአ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ አው፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ውስተ፡ ምኵራበ፡ አይሁድ፡ ወመካነ፡ ዕልዋን፡ ከመ፡ ይጸሊ፡[i] ከህናት፡ ይሰዐሩ፡ ወሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ።

If any of the clergy or of the laity enters the synagogue of the Jews or the place of heretics to pray – if he is a cleric, let him be deposed; and, if a layman, let him be cut off.

CANON 45

[i] Fell thought that the reading of the *MSS* (**ይጸሊ**) should be emended here (to **ይጸልዩ**), as it this word seems to have crept in because scribes mistakenly thought it should be joined with the following word (**ከህናት**).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵ወ፮።

በእንተ፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ሰብአ፡ እስከ፡ ይመውት፡ ወዘይትኃየል፡ ድንግለ።

ካህን፡ ለእመ፡ ተባአሰ፡ ምስለ፡ ካልኡ፡ ወይዘብጦ፡ ወይመውት፡ ይሰዐር፡ በእንተ፡ ግዝፈተ፡ ልቡ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ።

ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ተዐጋሌ፡ ድንግል፡ እምቅድመ፡ ትትፈጐር፡ ወይከውን፡ ምስሌሃ፡ ይሰደድ። ወኢያውስብ፡ ካልእተ፤ አሳ፡ ይንበር፡ ምስለ፡ እንተ፡ ተጎየላ፡ ወለእመሂ፡ ኮነት፡ ነዳይተ፡ ወሕሥምተ።

Canon 46

On one who strikes a man so that he dies and on one who does violence to a virgin

If a cleric quarrels with another and strikes him, and that man dies: let him be cut off[i], for the hardness of his heart. And if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

If a layman deceives a virgin before she is betrothed, and lives with her: let him be cut off. And let him not take another, but remain with her whom he violated, even though she be poor and ill-favoured[ii].

Canon 46

i The Ge'ez uses the same verb of the cleric and of the layman, so that both are cut off; Fell renders the first as '*deposed*' and the second as '*cut off*', which makes the penalties differ.

ii Fell prints *nequam* for the last word, queries whether it means 'despised', and a hand in his own copy glosses it *deformis*. The Ge'ez has **ሕሥምተ**, whose first sense is 'ugly' or 'deformed' and whose second is 'vile' (that is why the annotator wrote *deformis*). An early edition of Lumpkin's translation read '*of no account*', which takes only the second sense; '*ill-favoured*' is used now as covering both, though the word would bear a plainer rendering.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፵ወ፯።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ ካዕበ።

ለእመ፡ ረከበ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ኣው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ክልኤተ፡ ጊዜ፡ ተሠይመ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወዘሢሞ፤ አላ፡ ለእመ፡ ተዐውቀ፡ ከመ፡ ተሠይሙ፡ እምኀበ፡ ዕልዋን፤ እስመ፡ ኢይከውን፡ ግሙራ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩኑ፡ እለ፡ ተጠምቁ፡ አው፡ ተሠይሙ፡ እምኀበ፡ ሰብእ፡ ዘከመዝ፡ ይከውኑ፡ መሃይምናነ፡ ወኢካህናተ።

CANON 47

ON ONE WHO IS ORDAINED AGAIN [i]

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon receives ordination a second time: let both he himself and the one who ordained him be deposed; unless perhaps it is certain that they were ordained by heretics. For, those who have been baptised or ordained by men of that kind can by no means be faithful or clergy.

[i] In place of '*again*', Lumpkin has '*a second time*'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፰።

በእንተ፡ ዘኢይጸውም፡ ጾመ፡ አርብዓ፡ ወረቡዕ፡ ወዐርብ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ አናጕንስጢስ፡ አው፡ መዘምር፡ ለእመ፡ ኢጾመ፡ አርብዓ፡ ቅዱሰ፡ ወረቡዐ፡ ወዐርበ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ለእመ፡ ኢከልኦ፡ ሕማም፡ ዘሥጋ። ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ።

CANON 48

ON ONE WHO DOES NOT FAST THE FORTY [DAYS[i]] AND THE FOURTH AND SIXTH DAYS

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon or reader or cantor does not fast in the holy forty days, and on the fourth and the sixth day[ii] : let him be deposed; unless sickness of body has hindered him. And if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

CANON 48

[i] The word, '*Days*', is not present here in the Ge'ez, but is implied.

[ii] The fourth and sixth days are Wednesday and Friday – Lumpkin uses their names.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፱።

CANON 49

ለእመ፡ ጸመ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ ፭እምሥዩማን፡ ምስለ፡ አይሁድ፡ ወይገብር፡ ፋሲካ፡ ምስሌሆሙ፡ አው፡ ይትወከፍ፡ በኀቤሆሙ፡ አምኃ፡ በዓሎሙ፡[i] ናእተ፡ አው፡ ዘይመስሎ፡ ይሰዐር፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ።

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon, or any of the clergy, fasts with the Jews, or keeps the Pascha with them, or accepts from them the gifts of their feast – unleavened bread or something similar, let him be deposed. And, if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

ሕዝባዊ፡ ለእመ፡ ወሰደ፡ ኀበ፡ ምኵራበ፡ አሕዛብ፡ ወምኵራበ፡ አይሁድ፡ ቅብአ፡ ወማኅቶተ፡ ይሰደድ።

If any layman brings oil and lamps into the temple of the heathen or into the temple of the Jews: let him be cut off.

CANON 49

[i] Fell has here adopted the reading **አምኃ፡በዓሎሙ፡** (‘*gifts of their feast*’), following the Coptic version; *Codex B* has **አምኃ፡በበዓሎሙ፡** (‘*gifts on their feast day*’).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሰርቅ፡ ዘይተ፡ አው፡ ሠምዐ፡ አው፡ ዘኮነ፡ እምንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

ለእመ፡ ሰረቀ፡ ሥዩም፡ ሠምዐ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ አው፡ ቅብአ፡ ለይሰደድ፤ ወይፍዲ፡ ዘሰረቀ፡ ትጎምስተ።

ንዋየ፡ ብሩር፡ ወአልባስ፡ ለእመ፡ አስተርአየ፡ ጎዳጠ፡ መዋዕለ፡[ii] **ኢይንሣእ፡ ሰብእ፡ እምኔሁ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ለርእሱ፡ ባሕቲቱ፤ እስመ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ግብር፡ ጎጢአት፡ ውእቱ። ወለእመቦ፡ ዘገብረ፡ ዘንተ፡ ይስድድዎ፡ ወይትበቀልዎ።**

CANON 50

ON ONE WHO STEALS OIL OR WAX OR ANYTHING THAT BELONGS TO THE CHURCH

If any cleric steals the wax of the church or its oil: let him be cut off, and let him repay what he stole adding a fifth.[i]

Of the silver vessels and the vestments, if they are on view for a few days, let no one take anything for himself alone; for this is sin. And, if he does so: let them cut him off and take vengeance on him.

CANON 50

[i] The text here follows the Ge'ez (**ትጎምስተ**), with a fifth part added to the restitution, the rule of Lv 5:16; this also follows the Greek canon's *καὶ τὸ ἐπίπεμτον προστιθέτω μεθ' οὗ ἔλαβεν* ('*and let him add the fifth part to the amount he received*'); however, the Coptic reads ⲛⲉⲙ ⲡⲉϥⲕⲱⲃ ⲉ̄ ⲛⲥⲟⲡ (restore to him fivefold).

[ii] Fell prints these 4 words (**ለእመ፡ አስተርአየ፡ ጎዳጠ፡ መዋዕለ፡**) as obscure and says plainly that he does not know what they mean; his Latin takes **ጎዳጠ፡** for a form of the word meaning 'few', giving '*on view for a few days*'; however, it may instead belong to the verb meaning to be wanting, which would give '*if they are found missing for some days*', a sense that suits a canon about stealing the goods of the church better. Neither is certain and the passage wants a specialist in Ge'ez.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፩።

በእንተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘአስተዋደይዎ።

ሶበ፡ ያስተዋድይዎ፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ሰብእ፡ መሃይምናን፡ ጻድቃን፡ ወጌራን፡ ግብር፡ ውእቱ፡ ይጸውዕዎ፡ ኀበ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት። ወለእመ፡ መጽአ፡ ወይትአመን፡ ኀጢአቶ፡ ካዕበ፡ ይዛለፍዎ፡ ወይፍትሑ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ በኵነኔ፡ ዘይደሉ። ወለእመ፡ ጸውዕዎ፡ ወኢመጽአ፡ ወይጸውዕዎ፡ ካዕበ፡ ኀበ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ወ፪ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ይልአኩ፡ ኀቤሁ። ወለእመ፡ ኢተሰጥወ፡ ካዕበ፡ ይጸውዕዎ፡ ሥልሰ፡ ወይልአኩ፡ ኀቤሁ፡ ዳግመ፡ ፪ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት። ወለእመ፡ ኢተሰጥወ፡ ወአስተተ፡ ወኢመጽአ፡ ይፍትሑ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ እለ፡ ተጋብኡ፡ በዘይደሉ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ከመ፡ ዘተዛለፍዎ፡ እስመ፡ ጐየ፡ እምፍትሕ።

CANON 51

ON A BISHOP WHOM THEY HAVE ACCUSED

When faithful, just, and upright men accuse a bishop,[i] they must summon him before the bishops. If he comes and confesses his sin, then let them rebuke him and, in judgment, decree against him what is just. But, if they summon him and he does not come, let them summon him a second time before the bishops and send two bishops to him.[ii] And, if he does not obey, and scorns the summons, and does not come, then let those who are assembled decree against him what is lawful, so that it may be done to him as to one convicted, because he has fled from the judgment.

CANON 51

[i] Lumpkin adds '*of a crime*' (as also in the title).

[ii] Lumpkin adds, "*And if, again, he does not obey: let them summon him a third time, and send to him again two bishops*."

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፪።

ከመ፡ ኢይስምዑ፡ ስምዐ፡ ዕልው፡ ላዕለ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወኢስምዐ፡ አሐዱ።

ኢይትወከፉ፡ ስምዐ፡ ዕልዋን፡ ላዕለ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ ወኢይትወከፉ፡ ስምዐ፡ አሐዱ፤ እስመ፡ በአፈ፡ ፪ወ፫፡ ይቁም፡ ኵሉ፡ ነገር።

ወኢይከውኖ፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ የሀብ፡ ሢመተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና፡ ለእኁሁ፡ አው፡ ለወልዱ፡ አው፡ ለአዝማዲሁ። ወኢይሚም፡ ዘፈቀደ፤ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡ ርቱዐ፡ ከመ፡ ይትዋረሱ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና፤ ወኢየሀብ፡ ንዋየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በእንተ፡ ፈቃደ፡ ሰብእ፤ ወኢይደሉ፡ ይርስያ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያኑ፡ ለክርስቶስ፡ ርስተ። ለእመ፡ ገብሩ፡ ከመዝ፡ ወይነሥኡ፡ ከመዝ፡ ሢመተ፡ ይኩኑ፡ ከመ፡ ዘአልቦ፤ ወለሊሁኒ፡ ይትኰነን፡ በፍትሕ።

፩ዘነቋር፡ ዐይኑ፡ አው፡ ሐንካሰ፡ እግሩ፡ ወይደልዎ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና፡ ይሠየም፤ እስመ፡ ነውረ፡ ሥጋ፡ ኢያረኵሶ፡ አላ፡ነውረ፡ ነፍስ።

ጽሙም፡ ወዕዉር፡ ኢይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ አኮ፡ ርኩሰ፡ ከሚኖ፡ አላ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይዘረዉ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

ዘቦ፡ ጋኔን፡ ኢይሠየም፡ ካህነ፤ ወኢይጸሊ፡ ምስለ፡ መሃይምናን። ወለእመ፡ ነጽሐ፡ ያብእዎ፤ ወለእመ፡ ይደልዎ፡ ይሠየም፡ ካህነ።

CANON 52

THAT THEY SHOULD NOT HEAR THE TESTIMONY OF A HERETIC AGAINST A BISHOP, NOR THE TESTIMONY OF ONE BISHOP

Let not the bishops receive the testimony of a heretic against a bishop, nor let them receive the testimony of one bishop[i]; for by the mouth of two and three shall every word stand.

And it is not lawful for a bishop to bestow the episcopal office on his brother, his son, or his kin, nor to ordain whomever he wishes. For, it is not right that the episcopal office be inherited. Nor let him bestow the goods of God according to the will of men; nor is it fitting to make the Church of Christ an inheritance. If they do this and obtain office in such a manner, let them be as one whose ordination is nothing; and let him who ordained be judged by the law.

He who is one-eyed, or who limps on his foot, and is worthy of the episcopate: let him be ordained; for, a blemish of the body does not defile him, but a blemish of the soul.

A man who is dumb or blind shall not be ordained bishop – not because he is unclean, but lest the goods of the church be scattered.

He who has a demon, let him not be ordained a cleric, nor let him pray with the faithful. But, if he is made clean: let them receive him; and if he is worthy, let him be ordained a cleric.

CANON 52

[i] All the *MSS* read '*the testimony of one bishop*' here and in the heading; Fell struck the word bishop as unsuited to the sense, which turns on the rule of two or three witnesses, and rendered '*the testimony of one*'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፫።

ኢይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘተጠምቀ፡ ሐዲስ።

ዘመጽአ፡ እምአሕዛብ፡ አው፡ ዘሐይወ፡ በእኩይ፡ ወተጠምቀ፡ ኢመፍትው፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በጊዜሃ፤ ወኢመፍትው፡ ለዘኢተመከረ፡ ይኩን፡ መምህረ፡ ለባዕዳን፡ ሰብእ፤ አላ፡ ይኩን፡ ዝንቱ፡ በጸጋ፡ እግዚአብሔር።

ወኢይደልዎ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይንበር፡ ወያስተጋብእ፡ ምርካበ፡ አላ፡ ያስተርከብ፡ ግብረ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፤ ወለእመአኮሰ፡ ይገብር፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና። አልቦ፡ ዘይክል፡ ለክልኤ፡ አጋእዝት፡ ተቀንዮ፡ በከመ፡ አዘዘ፡ እግዚእነ።

ኢንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ይሠየም፡ ገብር፡ ካህነ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕተ፡ አጋእዝቲሁ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይጎዝኑ፡ አጋእዝቲሁ፤ እስመ፡ በዝንቱ፡ የሐጽጽ፡ አብያቲሆሙ። ወለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ገብር፡ በጊዜሁ፡ ዘይደልዎ፡ መዓርገ፡ ሢመት፡ በከመ፡ አስተርአየ፡ ለነ፡ አናሲሞስ፡ ወያግዕዝዎ፡ አጋእዝቲሁ፡ ወያውፅእዎ፡ እምአብያቲሆሙ፡ ወይሠየም።

CANON 53

THAT ONE NEWLY BAPTISED SHOULD NOT BE ORDAINED BISHOP

He who comes from the heathen, or has lived in wickedness and been baptised, may not lawfully be ordained bishop at once; nor is it fitting that he who has not been proved should be the teacher of men; but let this be by the grace of God.

It is not lawful for a bishop to sit idle and heap up gain, but let him give himself to the work of the church; if not, he does not discharge the episcopal office. No man can serve two masters, as our Lord appointed.

We appoint that a slave not be ordained a cleric without the permission of his masters, lest his masters be grieved; for, by this, their household is diminished. But if at any time a slave is found who is worthy of the rank of ordination – as Onesimus[i] seemed to us – let his masters free him and send him out from their houses; and then let him be ordained.

CANON 53

[i] The name, '*Onesimus*', is wanting in all the Ge'ez *MSS*; Recension II reads '*Simon*' and the Arabic titles have '*Aunisiphoros*'. Fell supplies the name (in his Ge'ez text) from the sense.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፬።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘይፀመድ፡ ሐራ፡ ወይፈቅድ፡ ይግበሮሙ፡ ለክልኤሆሙ፡ ከመ፡ ይርከብ፡ ሚመተ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወይርከብ፡ ሚመተ፡ ክህነት፡ ይሰዐር፤ እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ ሀቡ፡ ዘእግዚአብሔር፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ወዘንጉሥ፡ ለንጉሥ።

ዘያቀልል፡ ንጉሥ፡ አው፡ መኰንን፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ርቱዕ፡ ይትበቀልዎ። ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ካህነ፡ ይሰዐር፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዌ፡ ይሰደድ።

CANON 54

A bishop or presbyter or deacon who gives himself to military service and wishes to discharge both – that is, to exercise the office of men[i] and to exercise the office of the priesthood: let him be deposed. For the Scripture says, “Render what is God’s to God, and what is Caesar’s to Caesar.”

He who unjustly despises Caesar or the magistrate: let him be punished. And if he is a cleric: let him be deposed; but if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

CANON 54

[i] Here, ‘*men*’ follows the Ge’ez text, but the Greek (*ῥωμαϊκήν*) and other versions appear to have read ⲛⲓⲣⲱⲙⲉⲟⲥ (‘*Romans*’) instead of ⲛⲓⲣⲱⲙⲉ (‘*men*’).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፭።

በእንተ፡ ዘከመ፡ ይትወከፉ፡ እመጻሕፍት፡ ዘትካት፡ ወዘሐዲስ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን።

ወይኩን፡ እሉ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ኵሎሙ፡ ለካህናት፡ ወለሕዝባውያን፡ ቅዱሳነ፡ ወክቡራነ። ወእሉ፡ እሙንቱ፡ እምሥርዐት፡ ዘትካት።

CANON 55

WHICH BOOKS OF THE NEW AND OF THE OLD ARE TO BE RECEIVED IN THE CHURCH [i]

Let all these books be holy and honoured by the clergy and the laity alike; and these indeed are of the old order:

CANON 55

[i] Since there is no consensus among the Abyssinians regarding which books should be considered biblical, it is not surprising that almost every *MS* presents a different list. Besides the list found here, others are cited in Recension II of the Apostolic Canons, as well as in the second and third recensions of Abtilis; these, however, differ from one another. The list found in the book, *Fetha Nagast*, closely resembles that given here.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፮።

መጻሕፍት፡ ዘሙሴ፤ ዘፍጥረት፤ ዘፀአት፤ ዘሌዋውያን፤ ዘኍልቊ፤ ዘዳግም፡ ሕግ፤ ዘኢያሱ፡ ወልደ፡ ነዌ፤ ዘመሳፍንት፤ ዘሩት፤ ፩መጻሕፍት፡ ዘነገሥት፤ ቀዳሚ፡ ወካልእ፡ ፭መጽሐፍ፡ ሣልስ፡ ወራብዕ፡ ፭መጽሐፍ፤ ፪ትሩፋት፡ ነገሥት፤ ዘዕዝራ፡ ቀዳሚ፡ ወካልእ፤ ፭መጽሐፍ፡ ዘኢዮብ፤ ዘአስቴር፤ ዘጦቢት፤ መክብብ፤ መዝሙረ፡ ዳዊት፡ ፻፶፤ መሳልያተ፡ ሰሎሞን፤ ዘቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘጉባኤ፤ መሓልየ፡ መሓልይ፤ ፲ወ፪ንኡሳን፡ ነቢያት፤ ኢሳይያስ፤ ኤርምያስ፤ ዳንኤል፤ ሕዝቅኤል። ዘንተ፡ መሀሩ፡ ለደቂቅክሙ።

ዘእንበለ፡ ውእቱ፡ ጥበበ፡ ሰሎሞን፤ ዮዲት፤ ወመጻሕፍተ፡ ኩፋሌ፡ ፫፤ ዘኢያሱ፡ ወልደ፡ ሲራክ፡ ዐቢየ፡ ትምህርት።

ወመጻሕፍትኒ፡ እሉ፡ ዘሐዲስ፡ ሕግ፤ ፬ወንጌላት፤ ዘማቴዎስ፤ ዘማርቆስ፤ ዘሉቃስ፤ ዘዮሐንስ፤ ወግብረ፡ ሐዋርያት፤ ወ፩መልእክተ፡ ጴጥሮስ፤ ፫መልእክት፡ ዘዮሐንስ፤ ፩መልእክት፡ ዘያዕቆብ፤ ፩መልእክት፡ ዘይሁዳ፤ ፲ወ፬መልእክት፡ ዘጳውሎስ፤ ወአቡቀለምሲስ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ አርአያ፡ ዮሐንስ፤ ወ፩መልእክተ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፤

CANON 56

The books of Moses: Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy; Joshua son of Nun; Judges; Ruth; the 4 books of Kings, of which the first and second are one book, and the third and fourth again one; the 2 books of Chronicles; Ezra, the first and the second; one book of Job; Esther; Tobit; Ecclesiastes; the 150 Psalms of David; the Proverbs of Solomon; Ecclesiasticus; the Song of Songs; and the 12 minor prophets; Isaiah; Jeremiah; Daniel; Ezekiel. These writings teach to your children.

Besides these: the Wisdom of Solomon; Judith; the 3 books of Kufale[i]; and the book of Jesus son of Sirach, exceedingly wise.

Then let these books of the new law also be received: the four Gospels – of Matthew, of Mark, of Luke, of John; the Acts of the Apostles; two epistles of Peter; three epistles of John; one epistle of James; one epistle of Jude; 14 epistles of Paul; and Abuqalamsis[ii], which is the vision of John; and the 2 of Qalementos[iii].

CANON 56

[i] '*Kufale*' (**ሲራክ**) is the Book of Jubilees.

[ii] '*Abuqalamsis*' (**አቡቀለምሲስ**) is the Revelation of John.

[iii] '*Qalementos*' (**ቀሌምንጦስ**) is the Ethiopic form of the name Clement. Fell renders this entry as two epistles of Clement; its relationship to the Ethiopian work commonly called the *Book of Qälëmentos* requires further textual comparison – the name by itself does not settle it. Greek Apostolic Canon 85 includes both 2 Epistles of Clement and the Constitutions in 8 books, and these two entries should be distinguished when the lists are compared. The name is left here as the Ge'ez has it.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ወ፯።

በእንተ፡ ትእዛዛተ፡ ሐዋርያት።

ወዘንተ፡ ንኤዝዘክሙ፡ ኦኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ በእንተ፡ ሲኖዶስ፤ እስመ፡ ለእመ፡ ሰማዕክሙ፡ ዛቲ፡ ትትባለ[i]ሑ፡ ወትዴጎኑ፡ ወይከውን፡ ለክሙ፡ ሰላመ፡ ለዝሉፉ። ወለእመ፡ ኢተአዘዝክሙ፡ ወኢተወከፍክሙ፡ ዘውስቴቱ፡ ይካለቀክሙ፡ ወይከውነክሙ፡ ሐዘነ፡ በበይናቲክሙ፡ ለዝሉፉ፡ ወድኅሬሁ፡ ትረክበክሙ፡ ኵነኔ፡ ዘይደልወክሙ፡ በእንተ፡ ዕልወትክሙ።

ወእግዚአብሔር፡ ባሕቲቱ፡ ወወልዱ፡ ዋሕድ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ገባሬ፡ ኵሉ፡ ፍጥረት፡ ይረሲክሙ፡ ለለ፩ለኵልክሙ፡ ሰላመ፡ ወይርዳእክሙ፡ በኵሉ፡ ኀሩት፡ እንዘ፡ ኢታንቀለቅሉ፡ ወተሀልዉ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ርስሐት፡ እንዘ፡ አልብክሙ፡ ኀጢአተ። ወይረሲክሙ፡ ድልዋነ፡ ለመካነ፡ ሕይወት፡ ዘለዓለም፡ በወልዱ፡ ዘያፈቅሮ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ሕያው፡ ወመድኀኒነ፡ ዘቦቱ፡ ለከ፡ ምስሌሁ፡ ስብሐት፡ ለአብ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ለዓለመ፡ ዓለም፡ አሜን።

ዝንቱ፡ ሲኖዶስ፡ ዘሐዋርያት፡ ዘፈነዉነ፡ ምስለ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፤ ወስብሐት፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ለዓለመ፡ ዓለም፡ አሜን።

Canon 57

On the Canons of the Apostles

These things we command you, O bishops, concerning the Synod. If you hear it, you shall be safe and delivered, and there shall be peace to you for ever. But, if you do not obey, nor receive the things contained in it, God[ii] will deride you, and there shall be sorrow among you for ever; and the judgment that is your due for your disobedience shall lay hold of you.

And may the one God, and his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, and the Holy Spirit, the creator of every creature, give to you, to each one of you, peace, and help you in every good thing, while you are not shaken; and may you be without spot, having no sin. And may he make you worthy of the dwelling place of eternal life, through his Son whom he loves, our Lord Jesus Christ, the living one and our Saviour, to whom is glory with the Father and the Holy Spirit, world without end. Amen.

This is the Synod of the Apostles, which they sent with Clement. And glory be to God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Canon 57

i Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

ii The subject, '*God*', is supplied, because the Ge'ez leaves the verb without one. The verb is **ይካለቀክሙ** ('*he will deride you*') and it is singular, so a singular subject has to be understood, and God is the natural one. Fell, following the Coptic, would rather emend to '*they will deride you*', but that is plural where the Ge'ez form is not. The Greek reads instead that '*you shall be punished*'.